

STROBE Statement—checklist of items that should be included in reports of observational studies

Paper: Are peer reviewers influenced by their work being cited?

	Item No.	Recommendation	Page No.	Relevant text from manuscript
Title and abstract	1	(a) Indicate the study’s design with a commonly used term in the title or the abstract	1	
		(b) Provide in the abstract an informative and balanced summary of what was done and what was found	1	
Introduction				
Background/rationale	2	Explain the scientific background and rationale for the investigation being reported	1 to 2	First three paragraphs in introduction
Objectives	3	State specific objectives, including any prespecified hypotheses	2	“We had two research questions: ...”
Methods				
Study design	4	Present key elements of study design early in the paper	3	Study design section
Setting	5	Describe the setting, locations, and relevant dates, including periods of recruitment, exposure, follow-up, and data collection	2	Journal selection section
Participants	6	(a) Cohort study—Give the eligibility criteria, and the sources and methods of selection of participants. Describe methods of follow-up	2 to 3	Journal selection and Data extraction sections
		Case-control study—Give the eligibility criteria, and the sources and methods of case ascertainment and control selection. Give the rationale for the choice of cases and controls		
		Cross-sectional study—Give the eligibility criteria, and the sources and methods of selection of participants		
		(b) Cohort study—For matched studies, give matching criteria and number of exposed and unexposed	3	“We matched on article and version to control for confounding by any characteristics of the article”
		Case-control study—For matched studies, give matching criteria and the number of controls per case		
Variables	7	Clearly define all outcomes, exposures, predictors, potential confounders, and effect modifiers. Give diagnostic criteria, if applicable	3 to 4	Statistical methods section

Data sources/ measurement	8*	For each variable of interest, give sources of data and details of methods of assessment (measurement). Describe comparability of assessment methods if there is more than one group	2 to 3	Data extraction section
Bias	9	Describe any efforts to address potential sources of bias	3	Study design section and Supplements S.2, S.5 and S.6
Study size	10	Explain how the study size was arrived at	14	Supplement S.1
Quantitative variables	11	Explain how quantitative variables were handled in the analyses. If applicable, describe which groupings were chosen and why	3	Study design section
Statistical methods	12	(a) Describe all statistical methods, including those used to control for confounding	3 to 4	Statistical methods section
		(b) Describe any methods used to examine subgroups and interactions	17 to 18	Supplement S.5
		(c) Explain how missing data were addressed	N/A	
		(d) <i>Cohort study</i> —If applicable, explain how loss to follow-up was addressed <i>Case-control study</i> —If applicable, explain how matching of cases and controls was addressed <i>Cross-sectional study</i> —If applicable, describe analytical methods taking account of sampling strategy	3	“We matched on article and version”
		(e) Describe any sensitivity analyses	16 to 22	Supplements S.4, S.5 and S.6
Results				
Participants	13*	(a) Report numbers of individuals at each stage of study—eg numbers potentially eligible, examined for eligibility, confirmed eligible, included in the study, completing follow-up, and analysed	14	Figure S.1
		(b) Give reasons for non-participation at each stage	14	Figure S.1
		(c) Consider use of a flow diagram	14	Figure S.1
Descriptive data	14*	(a) Give characteristics of study participants (eg demographic, clinical, social) and information on exposures and potential confounders	5	Table 1
		(b) Indicate number of participants with missing data for each variable of interest	N/A	
		(c) <i>Cohort study</i> —Summarise follow-up time (eg, average and total amount)	N/A	
Outcome data	15*	<i>Cohort study</i> —Report numbers of outcome events or summary measures over time	N/A	
		<i>Case-control study</i> —Report numbers in each exposure category, or summary measures of exposure	5	Table 1
		<i>Cross-sectional study</i> —Report numbers of outcome events or summary measures	N/A	
Main results	16	(a) Give unadjusted estimates and, if applicable, confounder-adjusted estimates and their precision (eg, 95% confidence interval). Make clear which confounders were adjusted for and why they were included	19 to 22	Supplement S.6

		(b) Report category boundaries when continuous variables were categorized	N/A	
		(c) If relevant, consider translating estimates of relative risk into absolute risk for a meaningful time period	N/A	
Other analyses	17	Report other analyses done—eg analyses of subgroups and interactions, and sensitivity analyses	16 to 22	Supplements S.4, S.5 and S.6
Discussion				
Key results	18	Summarise key results with reference to study objectives	11	First paragraphs of discussion
Limitations	19	Discuss limitations of the study, taking into account sources of potential bias or imprecision. Discuss both direction and magnitude of any potential bias	12 to 13	Strengths and limitations section
Interpretation	20	Give a cautious overall interpretation of results considering objectives, limitations, multiplicity of analyses, results from similar studies, and other relevant evidence	11	Discussion section
Generalisability	21	Discuss the generalisability (external validity) of the study results	13	Paragraph in Strengths and limitations section
Other information				
Funding	22	Give the source of funding and the role of the funders for the present study and, if applicable, for the original study on which the present article is based	N/A	

*Give information separately for cases and controls in case-control studies and, if applicable, for exposed and unexposed groups in cohort and cross-sectional studies.